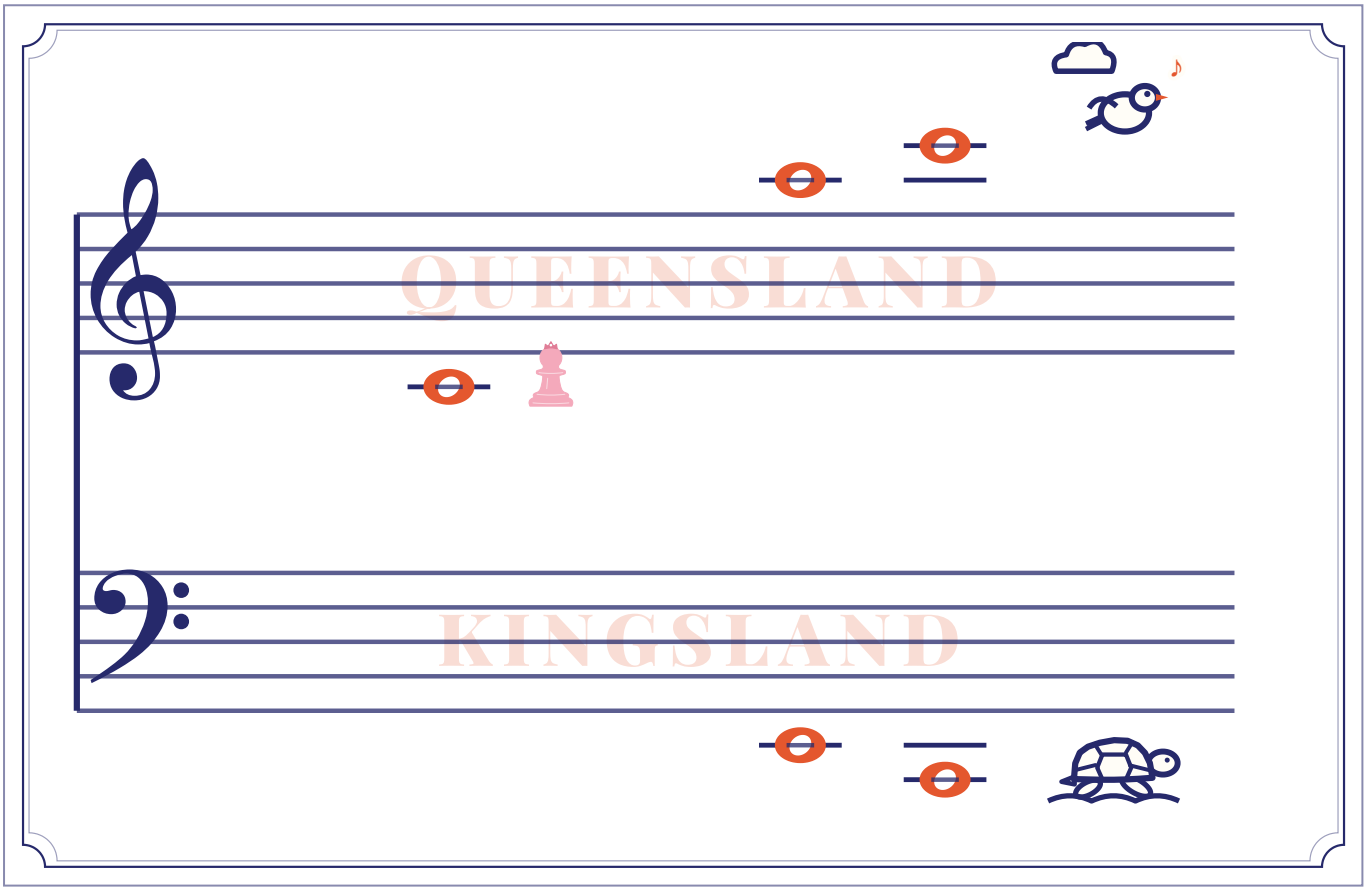
CHAPTER 6

Ledger Lines

Remember Clara's little ladder? It has a real name: a **ledger line**. Ledger lines are little ladders that let notes climb out of the lands -- up from Queensland into the bird's sky, down from Kingsland into the turtle's sea.



In this chapter

- ☐ Clara's ladder is a ledger line 2
- ☐ Up into the sky 3
- ☐ Down into the sea 4
- ☐ Between the lands 5
- ☐ Five Cs 6
- ☐ My five checks 7

By the end, you can

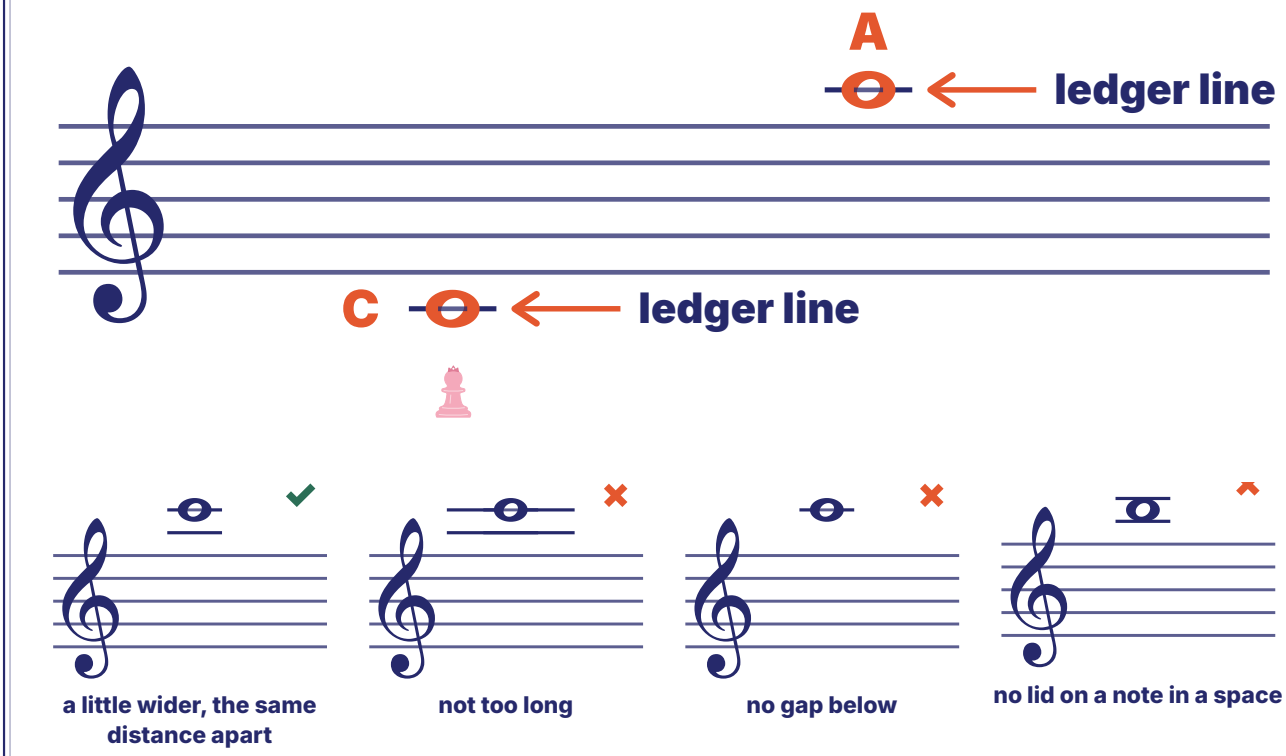
- ☐ say what a ledger line is and draw one neatly
- ☐ read up to three ladders above Queensland
- ☐ read up to three ladders below Kingsland
- ☐ read the ladders between the lands both ways
- ☐ find the five Cs from the sea to the sky

online

STEP 1

Clara's ladder is a ledger line

When a note is too high or too low for the five lines, we draw a short line just for that note -- a **ledger line**. Clara's ladder is one. The pattern carries on outside the staff: line, space, line, space. A ledger line is just **a little wider than the note**, the **same distance apart** as the staff lines, with **no gaps** back to the staff -- and never one more than the note needs: a note in a space gets **no lid** on top.



At the piano

1. Play Clara's C. The short line it sits on has a real name: a **ledger line**. ☐
2. Play one more note on a ledger line: the **A** on the ladder above Queensland. Clara's C and that A both sit on ledger lines. ☐

REMEMBER **A ledger line is a little ladder for one note: line, space, line, space -- the pattern goes on.**

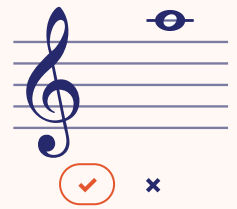
LESSON STEP 1

online
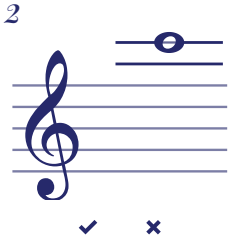
TRY IT Neat or not?

Circle ✓ if the ladders are drawn right, × if they are not: too long, a gap, or a lid on top.
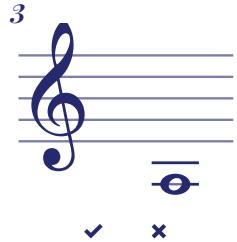
EXAMPLE
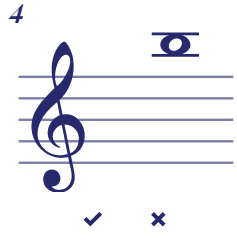


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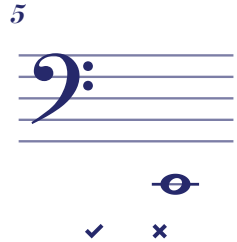


3



4



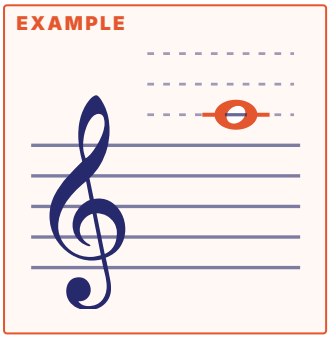
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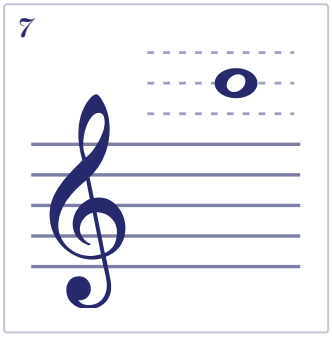


YOUR TURN Draw the ladders

Draw the ladders each note needs on the dotted lines. Some need none.

EXAMPLE
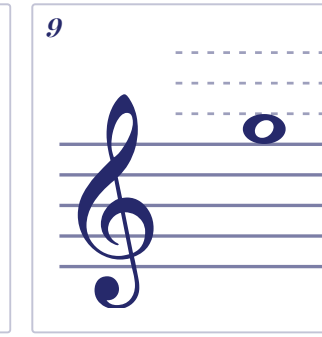


7



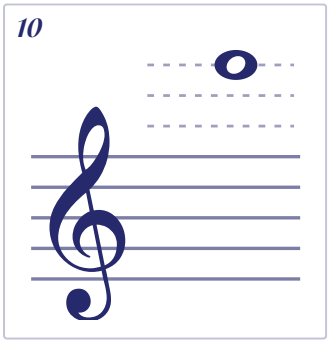
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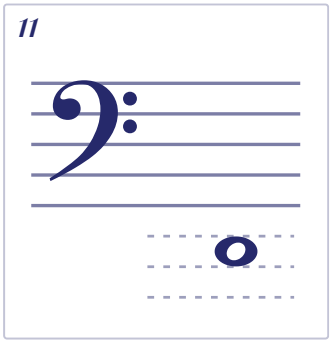


9



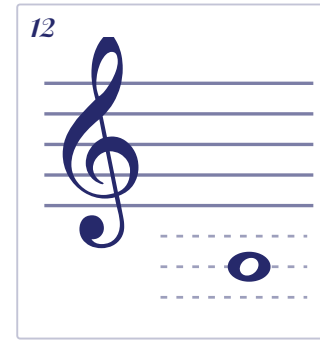
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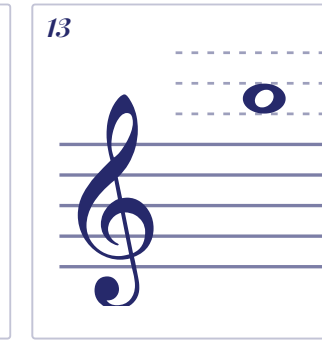


11



12

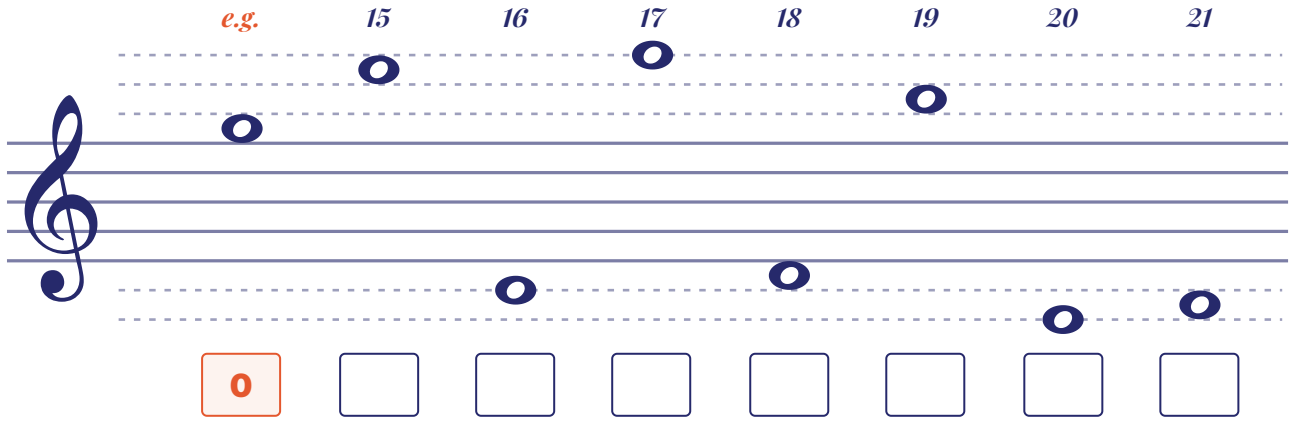


13



★ PLAY How many ladders?

The ladders are missing. Count the dotted lines out to each note: how many does it need? 0, 1, 2 or 3.

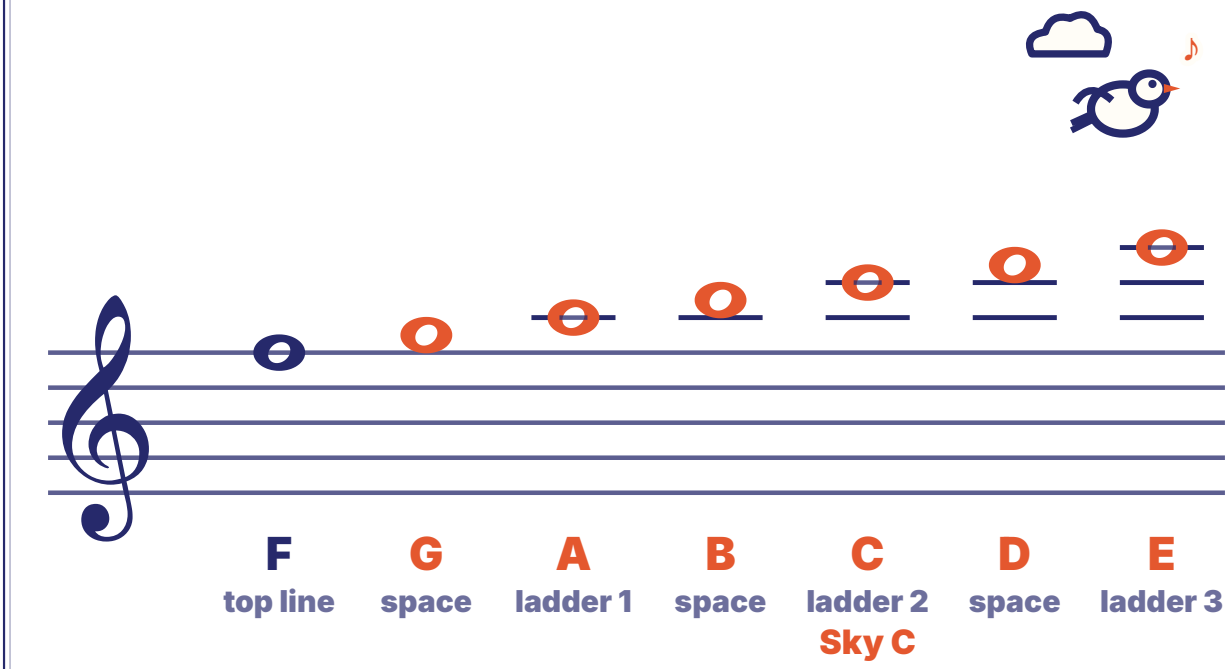


How did it feel? Circle one. ☺ 😐 ☹ CHECKED ☐

STEP 2

Up into the sky

Start on Queensland's top line, **F**. Just above it, in the space, is Chapter 5's **G**. Then ladder 1 carries **A**, the next space **B**, and ladder 2 carries **C** -- **Sky C**. Line, space, line, space: one letter a step, just like inside the staff. We go as high as **three ladders**: ladder 3 is **E**.



At the piano

1. With your right hand, climb from F: **F G A B C** -- "line, space, ladder 1, space, ladder 2". ☐
2. Find **Sky C**: from Clara's C, up to the next C, and the next. ☐

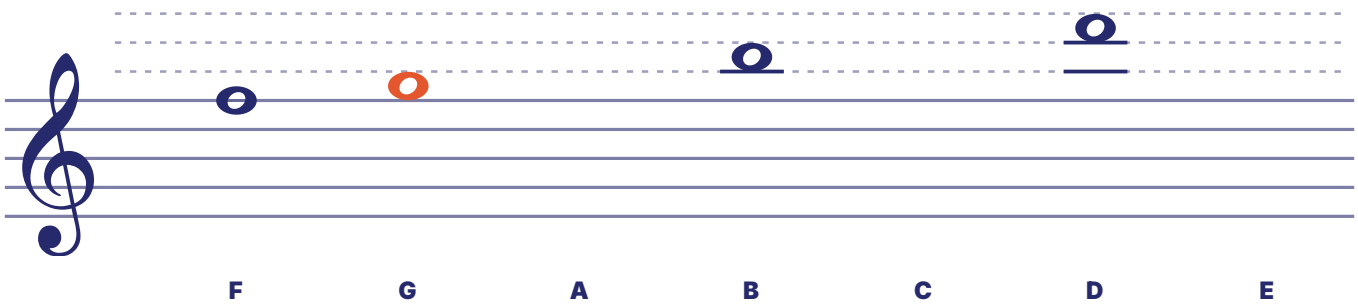
REMEMBER **Out of Queensland: G in the space, then A, C, E on the ladders.**

LESSON STEP 2

online

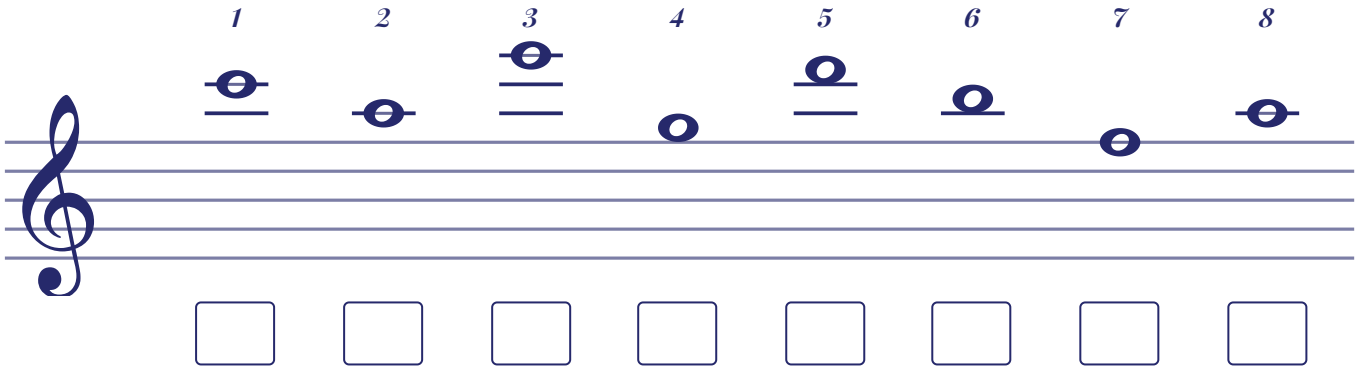
TRY IT The missing notes

Some notes are missing. Draw each one above its letter, one step up from the last, with its ladders.



YOUR TURN Name the sky notes

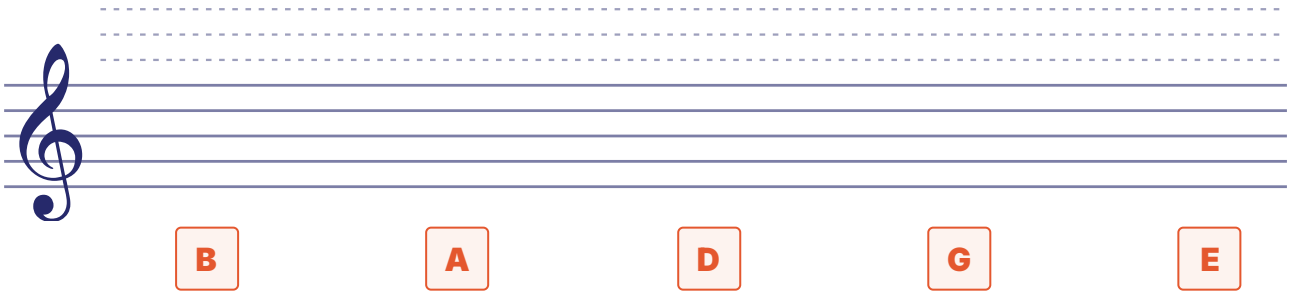
Count up from Queensland's top line, F, and write each letter.



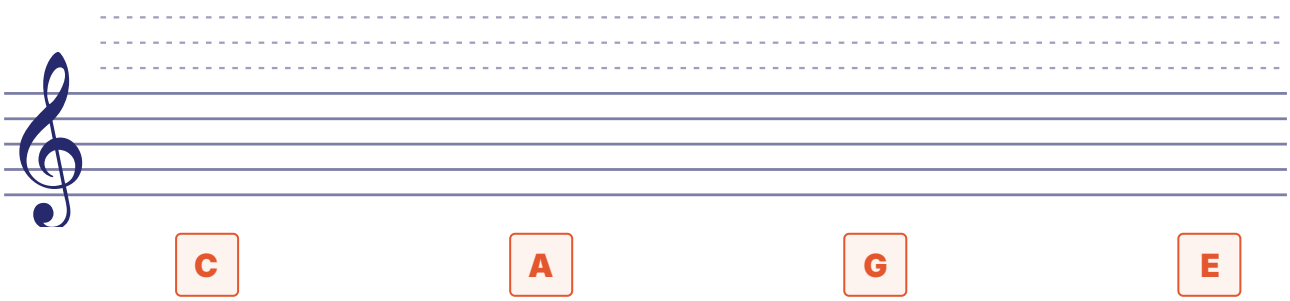
★ PLAY Words in the sky

Draw each note above its letter, with its ladders. Then play the words with your right hand.

9 · **BADGE**



10 · **CAGE**

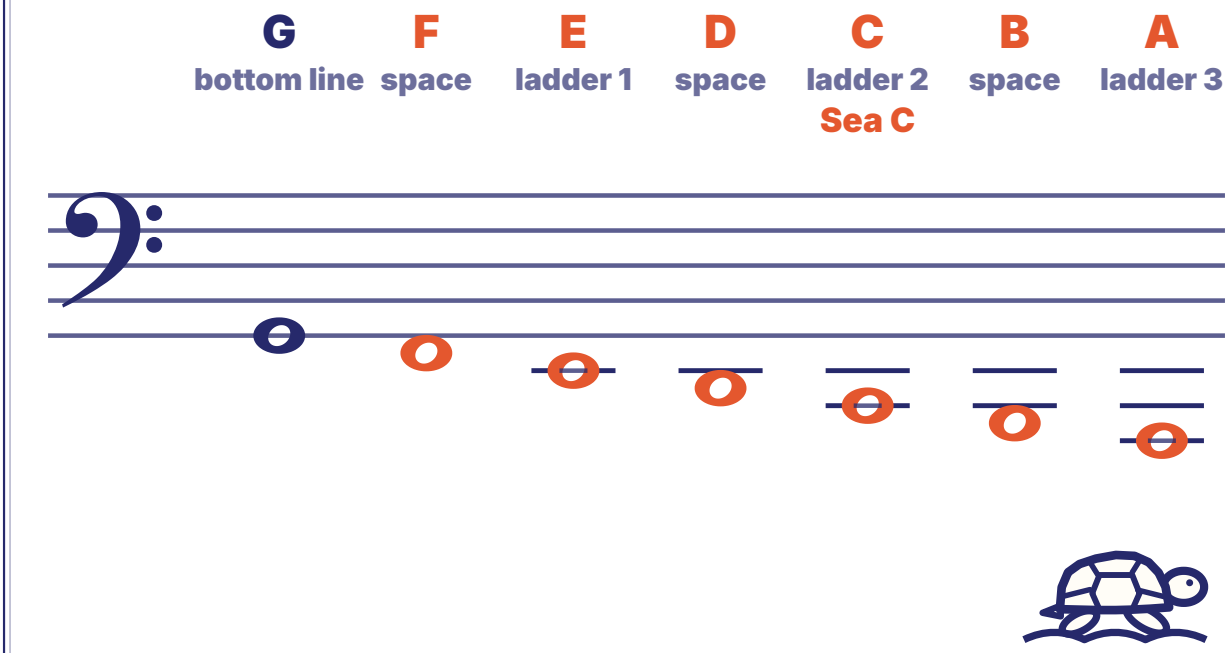


How did it feel? Circle one. ☺ 😐 ☹ CHECKED ☐

STEP 3

Down into the sea

Now climb down from Kingsland's bottom line, **G**. Just under it, in the space, is Chapter 5's **F**. Ladder 1 carries **E**, the next space **D**, and ladder 2 carries **C** -- **Sea C**, down in the turtle's sea. One letter a step, backwards: G F E D C. Ladder 3 is **A**.



At the piano

1. With your left hand, climb down from G: **G F E D C** -- "line, space, ladder 1, space, ladder 2". ☐
2. Find **Sea C**: from Clara's C, down to the next C, and the next. ☐

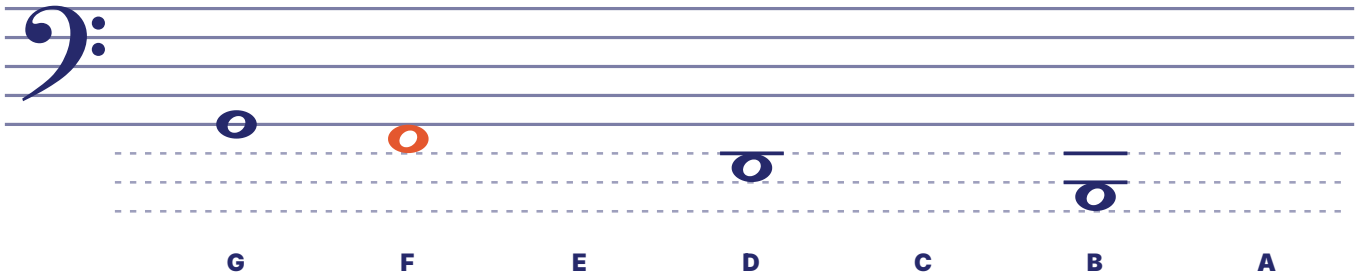
REMEMBER **Out of Kingsland: F in the space, then E, C, A on the ladders.**

LESSON STEP 3

online

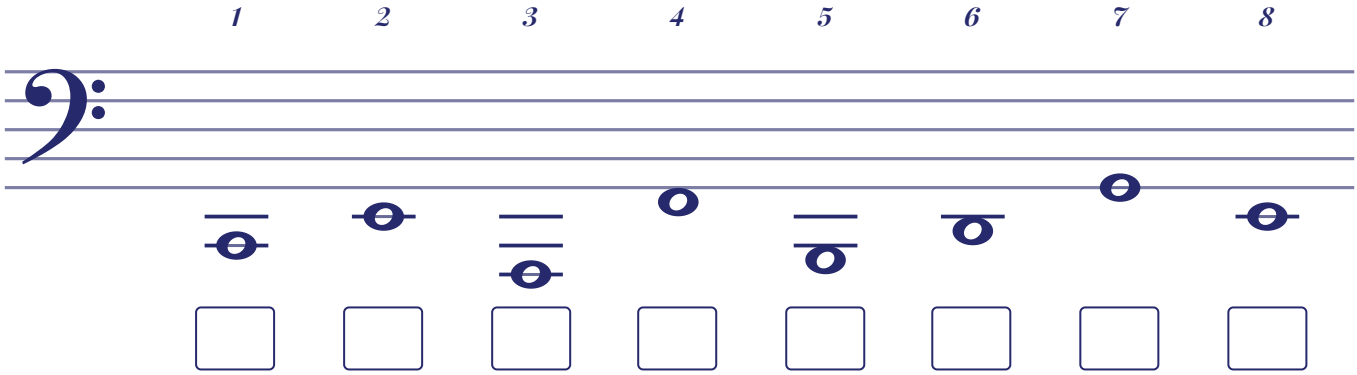
TRY IT The missing notes

Some notes are missing. Draw each one above its letter, one step down from the last, with its ladders.



YOUR TURN Name the sea notes

Count down from Kingsland's bottom line, G, and write each letter.



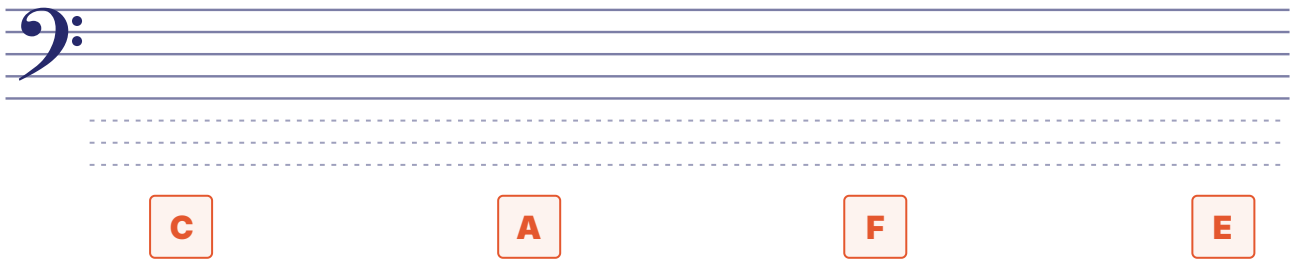
★ PLAY Words in the sea

Draw each note above its letter, with its ladders. Then play the words with your left hand.

9 · **BEAD**



10 · **CAFE**

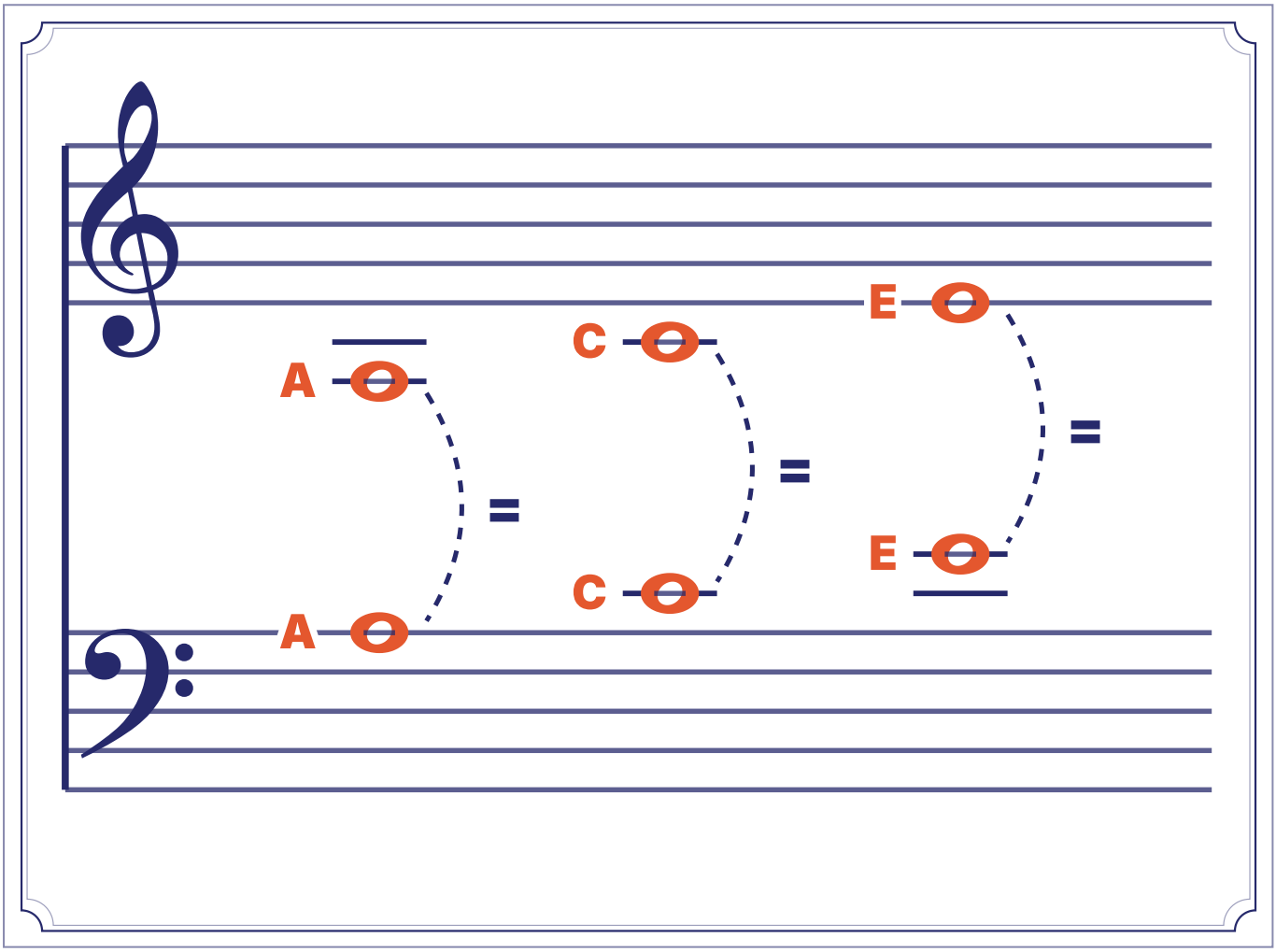


How did it feel? Circle one. ☺ 😐 ☹ CHECKED ☐

STEP 4

Between the lands

The ladders between the lands are **borrowed**. The A on **ladder 2 under Queensland** is the same key as Kingsland's **top line, A**; the E on **ladder 2 over Kingsland** is the same key as Queensland's **bottom line, E**. Clara's C sits on one ladder, seen from either land. The same key can be written two ways -- so each hand can stay in its own land.



At the piano

1. Play the three pairs above: A, C and E -- each once with the right hand, once with the left. The same sound! ☐
2. With your right hand, climb down out of Queensland: **E D C B A** -- "line, space, ladder 1, space, ladder 2" -- then point to Kingsland's top line, A. ☐

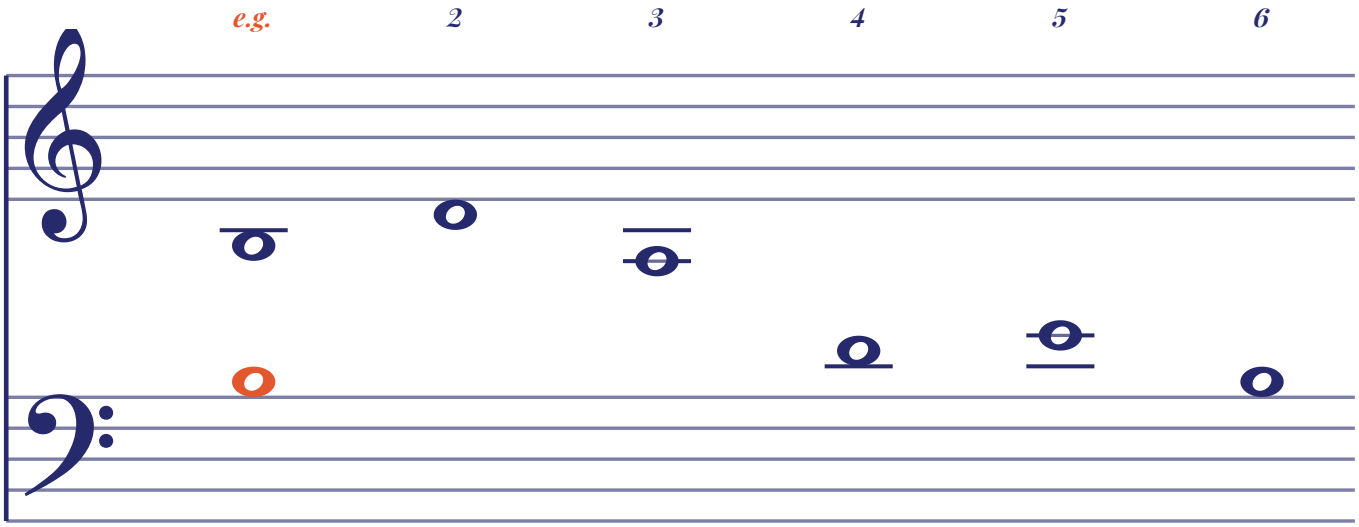
REMEMBER **Between the lands, the ladders are borrowed: the same key, two ways.**

LESSON STEP 4

online

TRY IT The same key in the other land

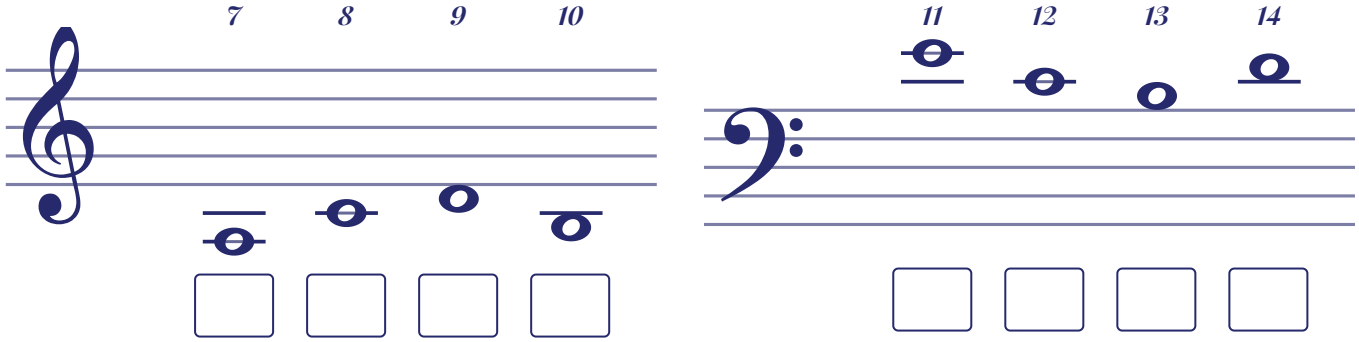
1-3: draw the same key in Kingsland. 4-6: draw it in Queensland. Write the letter.



B

YOUR TURN Read the borrowed ladders

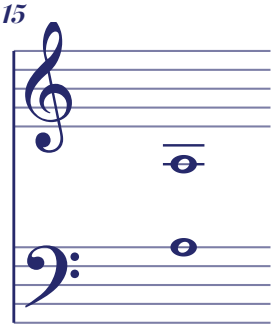
Whose land is the note in? Count out from that land, then write the letter.



★ PLAY Same key?

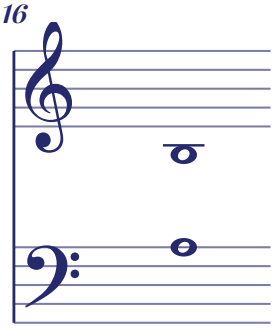
Each picture has a note in each land. Is it the same key on the piano? Circle yes or no.

15



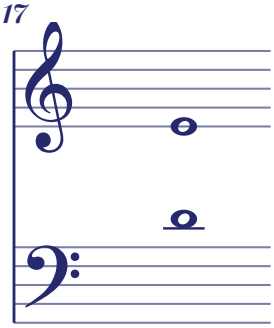
yes no

16



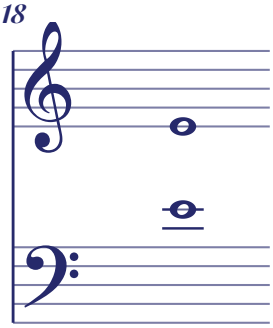
yes no

17



yes no

18



yes no

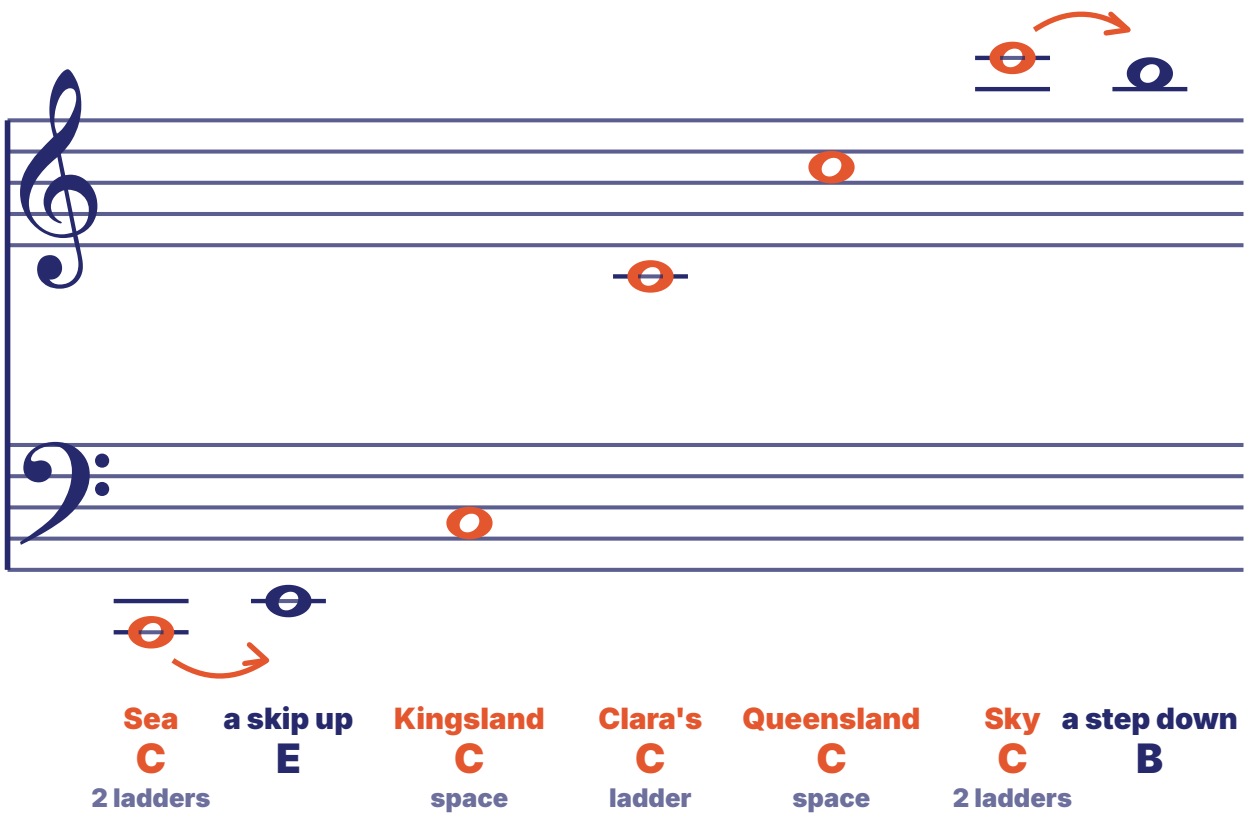
How did it feel? Circle one. ☺ 😐 ☹

CHECKED ☐

STEP 5

Five Cs

From the sea to the sky there are five Cs, an octave apart: **Sea C**, **Kingsland C**, **Clara's C**, **Queensland C** and **Sky C**. They take turns: ladders, space, ladder, space, ladders. Every ledger note in this book is a step or a skip from Sea C, Clara's C or Sky C.



At the piano

1. Play the five Cs from low to high, naming each one -- Sea C and Kingsland C with the left hand, the others with the right. ☐
2. **C hop:** your teacher points to a ledger note: nearest C → a step or a skip → name it → play it. ☐

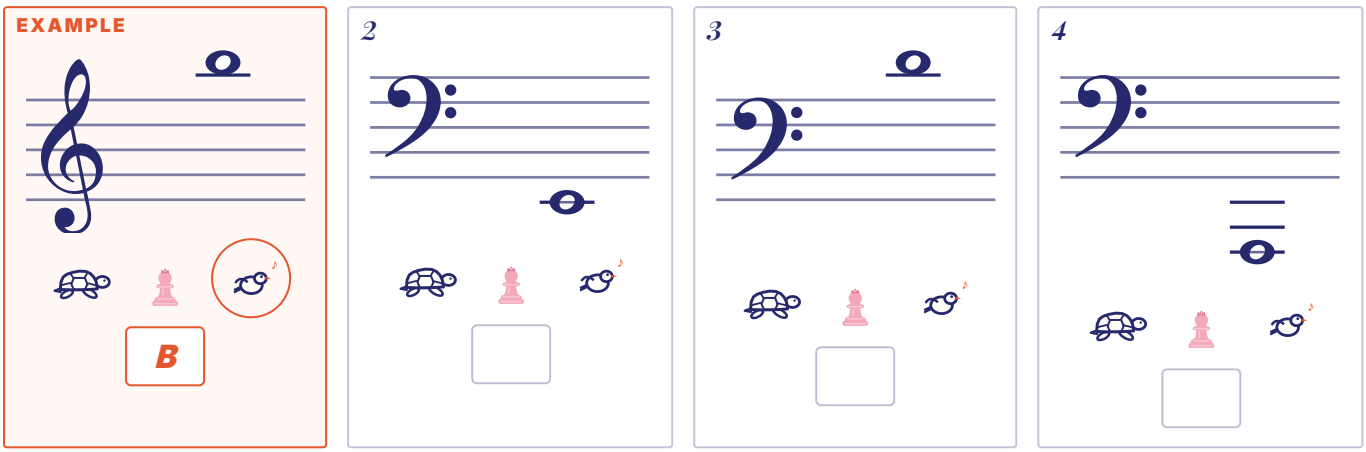
REMEMBER **Five Cs from the sea to the sky: find the nearest, then step or skip.**

LESSON STEP 5

online

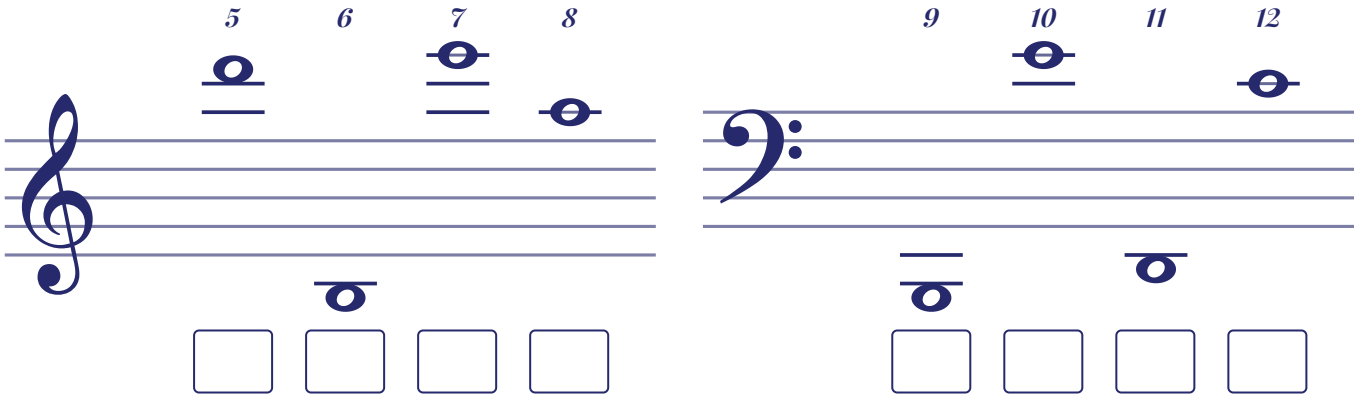
TRY IT Hop from a C

Circle the nearest C: the turtle's Sea C, Clara's C or the bird's Sky C. Then hop a step or a skip and write the letter.



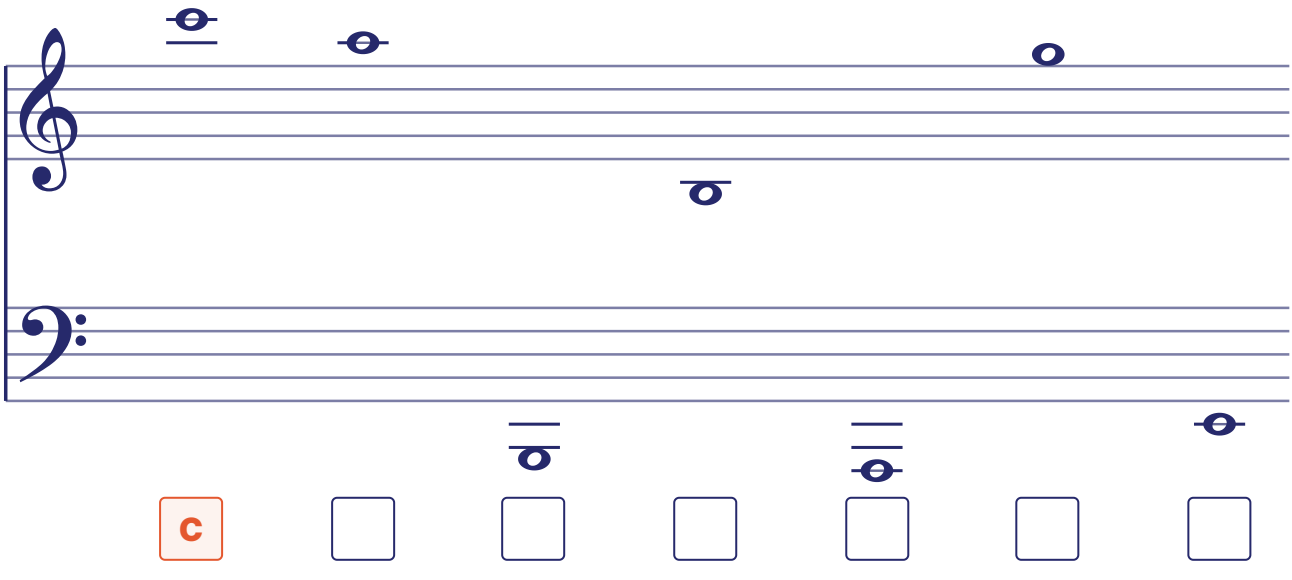
YOUR TURN Read them fast

Hop from the nearest C and write each letter.



★ PLAY The secret message

Write each note's letter, left to right. The word tells you what the turtle likes to eat.



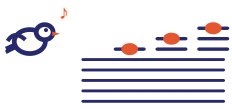
How did it feel? Circle one. ☺ 😐 ☹ CHECKED ☐

CHECK-UP

My five checks

Show each one at the piano, then tick how it is going -- not yet, nearly, or got it! The check-up on paper is in the Workbook.

At the piano

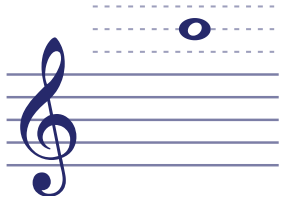
	NOT YET	NEARLY	GOT IT!
 **I can point to a ledger line and say what it is**	○	◑	☆
 **I can climb out of Queensland: G, A, B, C, D, E**	○	◑	☆
 **I can climb out of Kingsland: F, E, D, C, B, A**	○	◑	☆
A = A **I can read the ladders between the lands, both ways**	○	◑	☆
C C C C C **I can find all five Cs fast, from the sea to the sky**	○	◑	☆

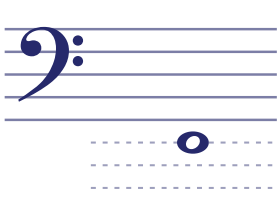
Colour a circle each time it gets better: not yet, then nearly, then got it!

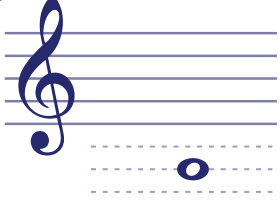
On paper

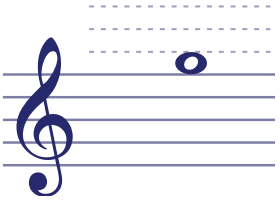
Name _____ Date _____ · no help, no piano · about 10 minutes

A **Draw the ladders each note needs on the dotted lines. Some need none.**

1 

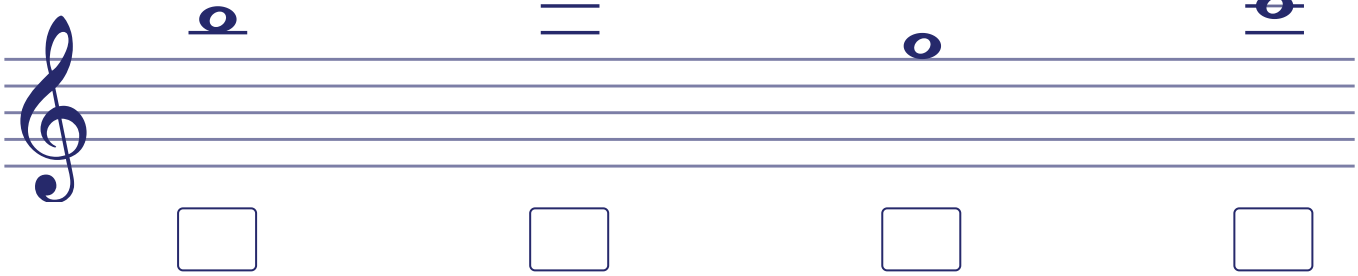
2 

3 

4 

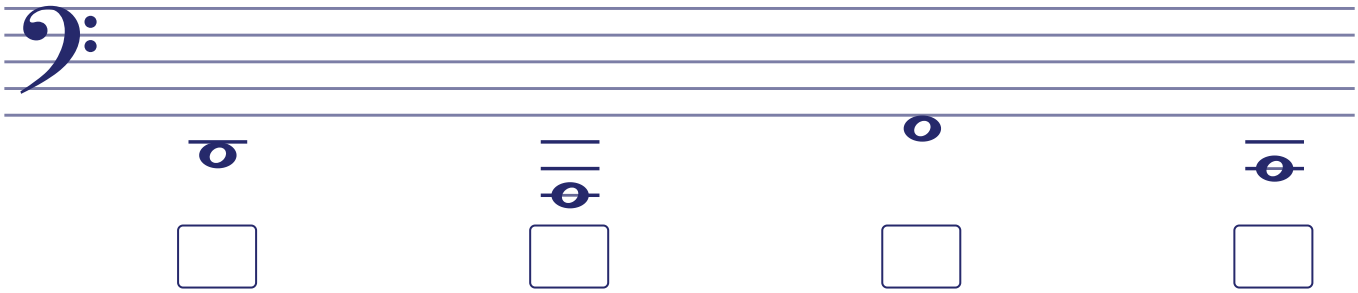
B **Up into the sky: name the notes.**

5 6 7 8
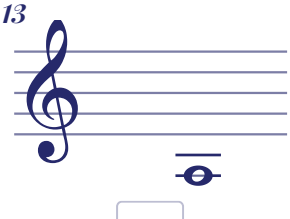


C **Down into the sea: name the notes.**

9 10 11 12

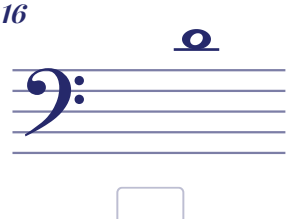


D **Between the lands: count out from the note's land, then name it.**
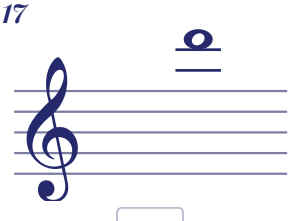
13 

14 

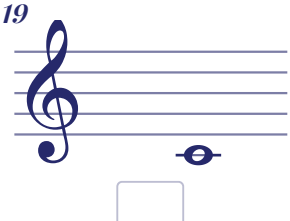
15 

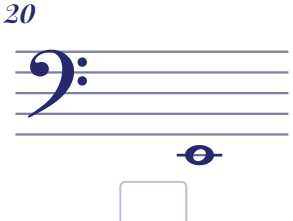
16 

E **Hop from the nearest C: name the notes.**

17 

18 

19 

20 

Teacher copy · Ledger Lines

Answers for every workbook page, the mistakes students make most, and a line to say when they get stuck. A ledger line is also spelled leger line (AMEB accepts both). Some books teach the ledger notes as four lists -- A C E above the treble staff, C A F below it, C E G above the bass staff, E C A below it; this book counts out of each land and reads from the five Cs instead. The lists' third notes between the lands (F three ladders under Queensland, G three ladders over Kingsland) come later. AMEB: Preliminary needs one ladder below Queensland; Grade 1 one ladder above and below both lands; Grade 2 up to three.

p. 2 Clara's ladder is a ledger line

TRY IT 1. ✓ 2. **× (too long)** 3. ✓ 4. **× (a lid on top)** 5. **× (a gap)**

YOUR TURN 6. **A: 1** 7. **C: 2** 8. **E: 1** 9. **G: 0** 10. **E: 3** 11. **D: 1** 12. **A: 2** 13. **B: 1**

PLAY 14. **0** 15. **2** 16. **1** 17. **3** 18. **0** 19. **1** 20. **2** 21. **1**

Watch for

Ladders drawn as one long line, a gap between the staff and the note, a lid on a note in a space (one line too many on top), ladders further apart than the staff lines. The notes just outside the staff (G over Queensland, F under Kingsland) need no ladder.

If stuck, try saying

"Count the ladders out from the staff: line, space, ladder..."

p. 3 Up into the sky

TRY IT **A ladder 1** **C ladder 2** **E ladder 3**

YOUR TURN 1. **C** 2. **A** 3. **E** 4. **G** 5. **D** 6. **B** 7. **F** 8. **A**

PLAY 9. **BADGE: B above ladder 1, A ladder 1, D above ladder 2, G just over the top line, E ladder 3** 10. **CAGE: C ladder 2, A ladder 1, G just over the top line, E ladder 3**

Watch for

Counting the ladders wrong: starting from the wrong line (start on the top line, F), or calling the space just over the staff a ladder. Sky C is on ladder 2, not ladder 3.

If stuck, try saying

"Line F, space G, ladder A, space B, ladder C -- Sky C."

p. 4 Down into the sea

TRY IT **E ladder 1** **C ladder 2** **A ladder 3**

YOUR TURN 1. **C** 2. **E** 3. **A** 4. **F** 5. **B** 6. **D** 7. **G** 8. **E**

PLAY 9. **BEAD: B below ladder 2, E ladder 1, A ladder 3, D below ladder 1** 10. **CAFE: C ladder 2, A ladder 3, F just under the bottom line, E ladder 1**

Watch for

Reading upwards by habit: below Kingsland the letters go backwards. Sea C is on ladder 2 under Kingsland.

If stuck, try saying

"Line G, space F, ladder E, space D, ladder C -- Sea C."

p. 5 Between the lands

TRY IT 1. **B → Kingsland just over the top line** 2. **D → Kingsland above ladder 1** 3. **A → Kingsland top line** 4. **D → Queensland just under the bottom line** 5. **E → Queensland bottom line** 6. **B → Queensland below ladder 1**

YOUR TURN 7. **A** 8. **C** 9. **D** 10. **B** 11. **E** 12. **C** 13. **B** 14. **D**

PLAY 15. **yes** 16. **no** 17. **no** 18. **yes**

Watch for
Reading a note under Queensland as a Kingsland note: it belongs to the land it hangs from, so count out from Queensland. The same key in the other land is written another way.

If stuck, try saying
"Whose land is it in? Count out from that land."

p. 6 Five Cs

TRY IT 1. **Sky C → B** 2. **Sea C → E** 3. **Clara's C → D** 4. **Sea C → A**

YOUR TURN 5. **D** 6. **B** 7. **E** 8. **A** 9. **B** 10. **E** 11. **D** 12. **C**

PLAY 1. **CABBAGE**

Watch for
Counting every ladder from the staff instead of hopping from the nearest C. Every ledger note in the book is a step or a skip from Sea C, Clara's C or Sky C.

If stuck, try saying
"Find the nearest C -- then a step or a skip."

p. 7 The check-up on paper (the Workbook's last page)

A 1. **C: 2 ladders** 2. **E: 1 ladder** 3. **A: 2 ladders** 4. **G: 0 ladders**

B 5. **B** 6. **E** 7. **G** 8. **C**

C 9. **D** 10. **A** 11. **F** 12. **C**

D 13. **A** 14. **E** 15. **B** 16. **D**

E 17. **D** 18. **B** 19. **C** 20. **E**

Watch for
Score each part on its own (4 marks, pass 3+). Not passed? Go back to that step's page: A p.2 · B p.3 · C p.4 · D p.5 · E p.6.

If stuck, try saying
"Count out from the land -- or hop from the nearest C."

LESSON TIME The C hop needs only note cards. Short lessons: set the drill levels as the week's practice -- a little every day, tracked on the student page. A Preliminary student can stop after level 1.